BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #71 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

# “God can't use me in this condition.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

Illness can erase roles in ministry, work, and family. When we cannot do what we used to do, we may feel set aside by God.

## What Scripture teaches

“God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.” “My power is perfected in weakness.” Moses said, “I have never been eloquent… I am slow of speech and tongue,” and God replied, “Who gave man his mouth?… Now go!” (Exodus 4:10–12). Gideon called his clan the weakest, and God said, “I will be with you.” Paul’s thorn became a platform for God’s power. God uses limited people because the power is His.

> *“But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong”* (1 Corinthians 1:27).

## Also see

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “‘Please, Lord,’ Moses replied, ‘I have never been eloquent, neither in the past nor since You have spoken to Your servant, for I am slow of speech and tongue.’ And the LORD said to him, ‘Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD? Now go! I will help you as you speak, and I will teach you what to say.’” (Exodus 4:10–12).

> “‘Please, my Lord,’ Gideon replied, ‘how can I save Israel? Indeed, my clan is the weakest in Manasseh, and I am the youngest in my father’s house.’” (Judges 6:15).

> “The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands” (Psalm 138:8).

## Common self-statements

- I am too limited.
- God needs strong people.
- I have been set aside.
- I can’t do what I used to.
- My usefulness is over.
- There is nothing I can offer.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing God uses only the strong or no one.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never serve again.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling limited and concluding that I am unusable.
- Labeling: Calling myself unusable.

## Challenging questions

- What have I told myself God needs from me?
- Whom did God use in Scripture who felt weak or limited?
- What can I still do: pray, encourage, write, listen?
- Who needs what I can give?
- What does Scripture say about power in weakness?
- What is one small service this week?

## Truth summary

> God does not need my strength. He works through weak and limited people to display His power. I can serve in ways that fit my condition.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Will of God
- Humility
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

**Just Be Held** — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

**Praise You in This Storm** — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

**Living Hope** — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

**Blessed Assurance** — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "God can't use me in this condition"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"God can't use me in this condition." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What have I told myself God needs from me?
- ☐ Whom did God use in Scripture who felt weak or limited?
- ☐ What can I still do: pray, encourage, write, listen?
- ☐ Who needs what I can give?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about power in weakness?
- ☐ What is one small service this week?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ God chooses the weak.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ He told Moses, "Now go."
- ☐ He will fulfill His purpose for me.
- ☐ I can serve within my limits.
- ☐ Small service counts.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:27
  *"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."*
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."*
- ☐ Exodus 4:10–12
  *"'Please, Lord,' Moses replied, 'I have never been eloquent, neither in the past nor since You have spoken to Your servant, for I am slow of speech and tongue.' And the LORD said to him, 'Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD? Now go! I will help you as you speak, and I will teach you what to say.'"*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Serving within limits: Each week, note one way you served.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, 1 Corinthians 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His power is made perfect in weakness.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] List what you can do. Write ways to serve within your limits.
- [ ] Pray for others. Choose a few people.
- [ ] Send encouragement. A card, call, or message.
- [ ] Ask your church. Find a fitting role.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God can't use me in this condition": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Serving within limits |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God can't use me in this condition.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I feel set aside. Show me how to serve within my limits, and display Your power in my weakness. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #72 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

# “I'm useless to the church now.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

When we cannot attend, teach, serve, or give as before, we may feel invisible to the church. Sometimes churches fail to include those who are limited.

## What Scripture teaches

“The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable.” “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good.” “Carry one another’s burdens.” Those who are ill can pray, encourage, give wisdom, and remind a congregation that the body includes the weak. The church also has a duty to care for the sick: “I was sick and you looked after Me.” You have a place, and the church should make room.

> *“On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable”* (1 Corinthians 12:22).

## Also see

> “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good” (1 Corinthians 12:7).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “I was naked and you clothed Me, I was sick and you looked after Me, I was in prison and you visited Me.’” (Matthew 25:36).

> “From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part” (Ephesians 4:16).

## Common self-statements

- The church does not need me.
- I contribute nothing.
- They have forgotten me.
- I am a burden to the church.
- I used to be useful.
- Only active people matter.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either active or useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that the church will forget me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling sidelined and concluding I am useless.
- Labeling: Calling myself useless.

## Challenging questions

- What roles can I still do, such as prayer, calls, and notes?
- Whom could I encourage?
- Have I told my church how I can participate?

- What does Scripture say about weaker members?
- What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- Who in church could help me stay connected?

## Truth summary

> The body of Christ needs its weaker members. I can pray, encourage, and share my story. I can tell my church what I need and what I can give.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Church
- Friendship
- Weakness
- Loneliness
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I'm useless to the church now"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I'm useless to the church now." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What roles can I still do, such as prayer, calls, and notes?
- ☐ Whom could I encourage?
- ☐ Have I told my church how I can participate?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about weaker members?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- ☐ Who in church could help me stay connected?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ I have a gift for the common good.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ The church should visit the sick.
- ☐ I can pray and encourage.
- ☐ I am part of the body.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  *"On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."*
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:7
  *"Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good."*
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still part of the body: Each week, note one contribution to the church.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, 1 Corinthians 12:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Weaker parts of the body are indispensable.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Church" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] Tell the pastor. Share your limits and what you can offer.
- [ ] Pray for the church. Choose a ministry to pray for.
- [ ] Write notes. Encourage others.
- [ ] Ask for visits. Let the church love you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm useless to the church now": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Still part of the body |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm useless to the church now.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I feel useless to Your church. Show me my place, and help the church embrace weaker members like me. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #73 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

# “My limitations disqualify me from God's purpose.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

We often equate purpose with achievement. When limitations constrain what we do, it seems that God’s purposes have passed us by.

## What Scripture teaches

“The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me.” “We know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose.” “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life.” Purpose includes loving God and neighbor in each season. Jacob walked with a limp after wrestling with God and was blessed. Your limits are not obstacles to God.

> *“The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever—do not abandon the works of Your hands”* (Psalm 138:8).

## Also see

> “And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose” (Romans 8:28).

> “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life” (Ephesians 2:10).

> “The sun rose above him as he passed by Penuel, and he was limping because of his hip” (Genesis 32:31).

> “Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus” (Philippians 1:6).

## Common self-statements

- My purpose is lost.
- I am out of the picture.
- God’s plan needs strong people.
- I cannot fulfill my calling.
- I am disqualified.
- Limits end purpose.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing purpose is either full or lost.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never fulfill my calling.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling limited and concluding I am disqualified.
- Labeling: Calling myself disqualified.

## Challenging questions

- What do I think my purpose is?
- Is purpose only doing, or also loving and trusting?

- How have people with limitations served God?
- What good works might God have prepared for me now?
- What can I do within my limits?
- Whom can I ask to help me see purpose?

## Truth summary

> My limits do not cancel God's purpose. He will fulfill His purpose for me, and I can love and serve within my condition.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Weakness
- Faith
- Guidance
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "My limitations disqualify me from God's purpose"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"My limitations disqualify me from God's purpose." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What do I think my purpose is?
- ☐ Is purpose only doing, or also loving and trusting?
- ☐ How have people with limitations served God?
- ☐ What good works might God have prepared for me now?
- ☐ What can I do within my limits?
- ☐ Whom can I ask to help me see purpose?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ The Lord will fulfill His purpose for me.
- ☐ God works all things for good.
- ☐ I am His workmanship.
- ☐ Good works are prepared for me.
- ☐ Limits do not disqualify me.
- ☐ God is faithful.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Psalm 138:8
  *"The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands."*
- ☐ Romans 8:28
  *"And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose."*
- ☐ Ephesians 2:10
  *"For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Purpose in limits: Each week, note one act of love or service.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Psalm 138:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord will fulfill His purpose for me.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] Rewrite purpose. Write love of God and neighbor as your purpose.
- [ ] Find one act. Serve in a way that fits.
- [ ] Ask a mentor. Seek perspective.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 138:8. Entrust your purpose to God.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My limitations disqualify me from God's purpose": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Purpose in limits |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My limitations disqualify me from God's purpose.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, fulfill Your purpose for me, even in limits. Show me how to love You and others each day. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #74 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

# “I have nothing left to give.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

Long illness, caregiving, or chronic fatigue can leave us depleted. With no energy to give, we may feel empty and ashamed.

## What Scripture teaches

Peter said to the lame man, “Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you.” We always have something. Jesus said, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.” You may need to receive before you give. “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you.” Rest is not failure. In due time you will have more to share, and meanwhile your presence, prayers, and gratitude bless others.

> *“But Peter said, ‘Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!’”* (Acts 3:6).

## Also see

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).
>
> “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken” (Psalm 55:22).
>
> “He gives power to the faint and increases the strength of the weak” (Isaiah 40:29).
>
> “Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Galatians 6:9).

## Common self-statements

- I am empty.
- I cannot help anyone.
- I have no energy.
- I am a taker.
- I have nothing to offer.
- Everyone gives more than I do.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either giving fully or giving nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be empty.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling depleted and concluding that I have nothing.
- Labeling: Calling myself empty.

## Challenging questions

- What do I still have: time, prayers, listening, thanks?
- Whom could I bless in a small way?
- What do I need to receive first?
- Who might want to give to me?
- What does Scripture say about rest and strength?

- What is one small thing I can give?

## Truth summary

> I may be depleted, but I am not empty-handed. I can receive rest and care from God and others, and give small things as strength allows. My presence and prayers matter.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Tired
- Weakness
- Humility
- Suffering
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

**Just Be Held** — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

**Praise You in This Storm** — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

**Living Hope** — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

**Blessed Assurance** — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I have nothing left to give"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I have nothing left to give." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What do I still have: time, prayers, listening, thanks?
- ☐ Whom could I bless in a small way?
- ☐ What do I need to receive first?
- ☐ Who might want to give to me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about rest and strength?
- ☐ What is one small thing I can give?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ What I have, I give.
- ☐ Jesus gives rest to the weary.
- ☐ The Lord sustains me.
- ☐ He gives power to the faint.
- ☐ Receiving is part of the cycle.
- ☐ Small gifts count.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Acts 3:6
  *"But Peter said, 'Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!'"*
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  *"Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."*
- ☐ Psalm 55:22
  *"Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken."*

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Receiving and giving: Each week, note one thing you received and one you gave.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Acts 3:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus gives rest to the weary.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] Rest. Schedule real rest.
- [ ] Receive. Accept help and kindness.
- [ ] Give small. Send a note or pray.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 40:29. Ask for strength.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have nothing left to give": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Receiving and giving |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have nothing left to give.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I am empty. Restore me, give me strength, and let me give what I can. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #75 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

# “Only healthy, strong people can serve God well.”

✦ ✦ ✦

## Where it often comes from

Church culture often celebrates energetic, visible service. Those with chronic illness or limits may feel their service is inferior or unseen.

## What Scripture teaches

“God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.” “My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.” Peter and John, “unschooled, ordinary men,” astonished the council because “they had been with Jesus.” Epaphroditus served “nearly unto death.” Paul wrote letters from prison. God values faithfulness, love, and prayer, and often shows His power most through the weak.

> *“But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me”* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

## Also see

> “But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong” (1 Corinthians 1:27).

> “When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus” (Acts 4:13).

> “He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow” (Philippians 2:27).

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” (1 Corinthians 12:22).

## Common self-statements

- Only the strong can serve.
- My service does not count.
- I am a spectator.
- God prefers healthy workers.
- My weakness hinders God.
- Visible service matters more.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing service is either strong or worthless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that my service is useless.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling weak and concluding I cannot serve well.
- Labeling: Calling my service worthless.

## Challenging questions

- What has God done through weak people in Scripture?

- What acts of service are within my reach?
- How has my weakness made me more compassionate?
- What do I admire in the quiet servants I know?
- What does Scripture say about God's power in weakness?
- What is one way I can serve this week?

## Truth summary

> God does not need strong servants. He uses weak ones to show His power. My faithfulness, prayers, and love count as real service.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Humility
- Faith
- Will of God
- Suffering

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## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

# My Plan for Replacing "Only healthy, strong people can serve God well"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"Only healthy, strong people can serve God well." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What has God done through weak people in Scripture?
- ☐ What acts of service are within my reach?
- ☐ How has my weakness made me more compassionate?
- ☐ What do I admire in the quiet servants I know?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's power in weakness?
- ☐ What is one way I can serve this week?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ God chooses the weak.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ Ordinary people with Jesus do great things.
- ☐ Faithfulness counts.
- ☐ Prayer is service.
- ☐ I can serve this week.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ **2 Corinthians 12:9**
  *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."*
- ☐ **1 Corinthians 1:27**
  *"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."*
- ☐ **Acts 4:13**
  *"When they saw the boldness of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they marveled and took note that these men had been with Jesus."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

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### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Faithful in weakness: Each week, note one act of faithful service.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His power is perfected in my weakness.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
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## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] List your service. Prayer, notes, listening.
- [ ] Appreciate quiet servants. Thank one.
- [ ] Serve once. Choose one act this week.
- [ ] Memorize 2 Corinthians 12:9. Say it when you feel weak.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Only healthy, strong people can serve God well": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Faithful in weakness |
|---|---|---|---|---|
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After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Only healthy, strong people can serve God well.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, use me in my weakness. Thank You that Your power is made perfect there. Help me serve faithfully with what I have. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*